ISSUE
No
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📅 AUGUST 29, 2026
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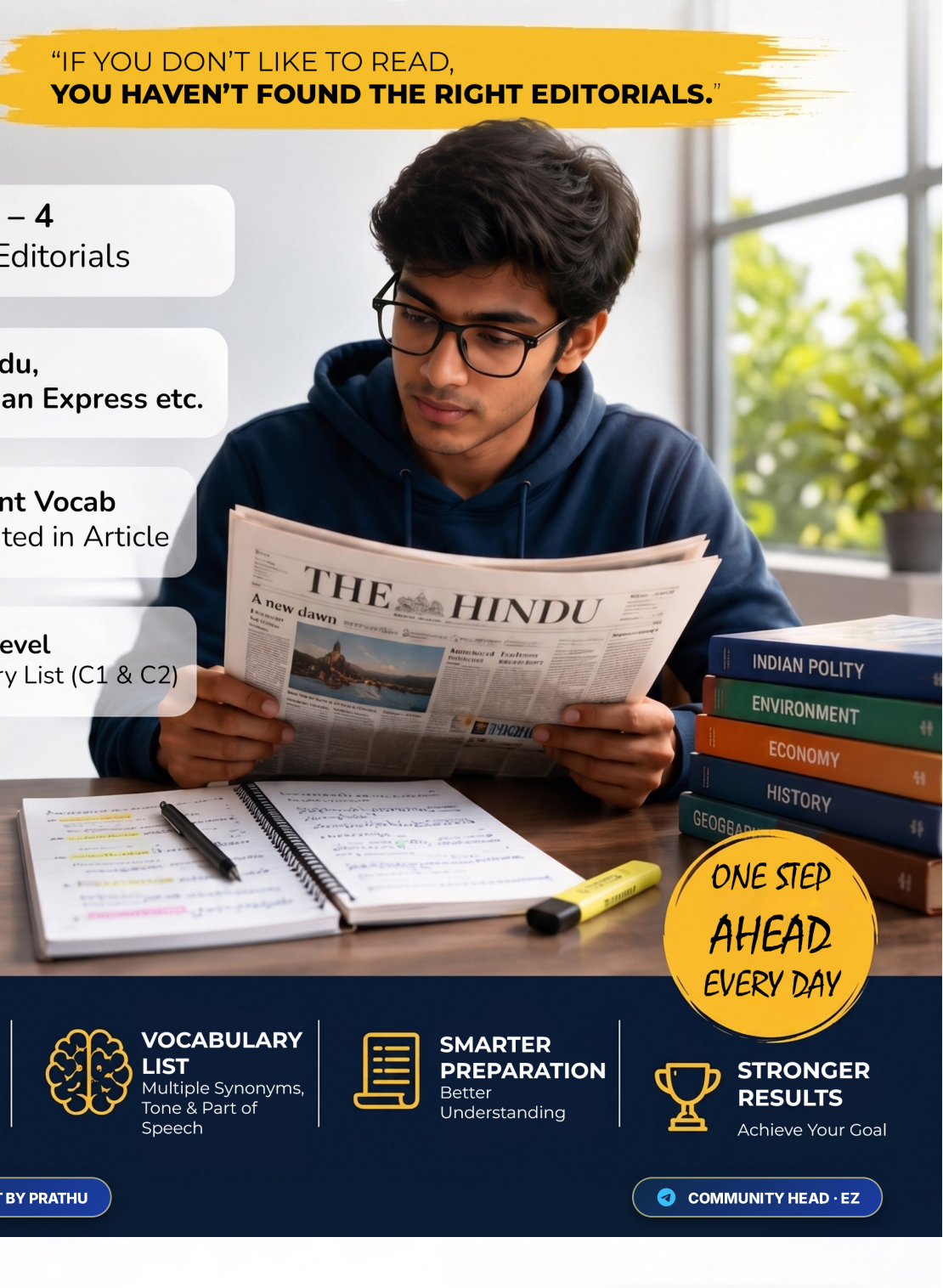
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📅 AUGUST 29, 2026

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> *No. I can survive well enough on my own— if given the proper reading material.*
>
> -SARAH J. MAAS

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THE HINDU • ELECTORAL GOVERNANCE & DEMOCRATIC RIGHTS

Unkind cuts: On the Telangana and Karnataka electoral rolls

Large-scale voter deletions by the Election Commission threaten democratic participation and universal adult franchise.

📅 August 29, 2026 ◷ 3 min read DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process being conducted by the Election Commission of India (ECI) is increasingly leading to a clear case of **disenfranchisement**[1] in several parts of India. **Marauding on**[2] after a judgment by the Supreme Court of India allowed it to proceed, the SIR has now **struck out**[3] a fifth of the names from the electoral rolls in Telangana and Karnataka — nearly 22% and 19.5% respectively — and among the highest in the country. The cuts are **steepest**[4] in their capital cities — five constituencies in Bengaluru have lost more than half of their electors while nine of Hyderabad's 15 have seen deletions of more than 40%. Cuts of this kind cannot simply be a **trimming**[5] of **bloated**[6] rolls **at the margins**[7]. If they are accurate, the ECI's own summary revision processes were yielding **bloated**[6] rolls in recent elections, and doing so in the very places with high net **in-migration**[8] from the rest of India. And if the deletions are to be justified, those **struck off**[9] the rolls must have left the States — a move within Karnataka or Telangana would only relocate a voter's name on the same State roll, not remove it altogether. Yet, this is neither **borne out**[10] by recent survey data nor by the government's own population estimates.

During the Bihar SIR, the Court asked why political parties had filed so few objections, seeking inclusion of wrongly deleted names; that question might hold true for the Southern States as well. A **plausible**[11] reason could be that the voter id is useful to a citizen only once in a few years, leading to less **alacrity**[12] on their part. This may explain why a process that puts the **onus on**[13] electors yields cuts of this scale. Meanwhile, proving a **smoking gun**[14] in the data is difficult because of the ECI's **opacity**[15]. It has not published the elector-to-population ratio for any State so far during the revision even though doing so is mandatory and is the only test of under-enrolment. The Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer has not even bothered to release a gender-wise breakdown of the deletions, instead scattering the lists across several Google Drive links without the old booth numbers, making verification **arduous**[16]. The outcome of such **shoddiness**[17] is visible in West Bengal, where the ECI's **dubious**[18] "logical discrepancy" process disenfranchised lakhs of electors, forcing them to seek **redress**[19] before tribunals set up **under the aegis of**[20] the Court. Months after the elections, records obtained under a Right to Information request show that barely 82,000 of the nearly 38 lakh appeals before the 19 tribunals have been decided, with more than 90% of those decisions favouring electors seeking **restoration**[21]. The ECI — an institution once **envied**[22] even by wealthier democracies for bringing large numbers of Indians to the polling booth — is now an obstacle to **universal adult franchise**[23].

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **disenfranchisement** (Noun) voter exclusion • मताधिकार से वंचित करना
2. **Marauding on** (Verb phrase) plundering ahead • विध्वंसक रूप से आगे बढ़ते रहना
3. **struck out** (Verb phrase) deleted • हटा दिया / काट दिया
4. **steepest** (Adjective) sharpest • सबसे तीव्र / अत्यधिक
5. **trimming** (Noun) reduction • छंटाई
6. **bloated** (Adjective) overinflated • अतिविस्तारित / फूला हुआ
7. **at the margins** (Prepositional phrase) slightly • मामूली स्तर पर / किनारों पर
8. **in-migration** (Noun) incoming movement • अंतःप्रवासन
9. **struck off** (Verb phrase) deregistered • सूची से हटा दिया गया
10. **borne out** (Verb phrase) confirmed • पुष्टि होना / सच साबित होना
11. **plausible** (Adjective) believable • संभावित / विश्वसनीय
12. **alacrity** (Noun) eagerness • तत्परता / फुर्ती
13. **onus on** (Noun phrase) burden on • का दायित्व
14. **smoking gun** (Noun phrase) clear proof • प्रत्यक्ष अकाट्य सबूत
15. **opacity** (Noun) lack of clarity • अपारदर्शिता
16. **arduous** (Adjective) tiring • कठिन / श्रमसाध्य
17. **shoddiness** (Noun) poor quality • घटियापन / लापरवाही
18. **dubious** (Adjective) suspect • संदिग्ध
19. **redress** (Noun) remedy • निवारण / भरपाई
20. **under the aegis of** (Prepositional phrase) backed by • के संरक्षण / तत्वावधान में
21. **restoration** (Noun) reinstatement • बहाली
22. **envied** (Verb) admired • ईर्ष्या या प्रशंसा का पात्र
23. **universal adult franchise** (Noun phrase) universal suffrage • सार्वभौमिक वयस्क मताधिकार

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Source: The Hindu Published: August 29, 2026 12:20 AM IST

EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Unkind cuts: On the Telangana and Karnataka electoral rolls
THE HINDU • ELECTORAL GOVERNANCE & DEMOCRATIC RIGHTS

EDITORIAL STANCE
CRITICAL
"harshly fault-finding"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author adopts a sharply critical tone to highlight the alarming scale of voter deletions carried out by the Election Commission in Karnataka and Telangana. Pointing to severe procedural opacity, questionable deletion criteria, and high reversal rates in tribunals, the piece warns that the poll body risks undermining universal adult franchise.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY 10 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**steepest** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	सबसे तीव्र / अत्यधिक The sharpest, most drastic, or extreme in terms of rate or magnitude of decline.	A 'steep' slope is very sharp and sudden; steepest means the most extreme drop.	• sharpest • most drastic • most precipitous	• gentlest • mildest • most gradual
02	**trimming** NOUN NEUTRAL	छंटाई The act of reducing, cutting back, or removing unnecessary parts from something.	Like trimming hair or hedges — making small, neat cuts to tidy up.	• pruning • paring down • curtailment	• expansion • augmentation • amplification
03	**bloated** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अतिविस्तारित / फूला हुआ Excessively large, swollen, or inflated beyond reasonable proportions.	When a stomach is 'bloated', it is swollen and excessively full.	• inflated • distended • oversized	• lean • streamlined • deflated
04	**plausible** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	संभावित / विश्वसनीय Seeming reasonable, probable, or likely to be true based on available logic.	Plausible sounds like 'applause-able' — an argument good enough to applaud.	• credible • convincing • tenable	• implausible • untenable • improbable
05	**alacrity** NOUN POSITIVE	तत्परता / फुर्ती Brisk and cheerful readiness, promptness, or speed in doing something.	Think of 'a lively city' — moving with quickness, energy, and eagerness.	• promptness • eagerness • keenness	• reluctance • lethargy • hesitance
06	**arduous** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	कठिन / श्रमसाध्य Involving or requiring strenuous effort, extreme energy, and tiring labour.	Hard for 'us' = arduous; requires intense physical or mental effort.	• onerous • strenuous • laborious	• effortless • facile • easy
07	**shoddiness** NOUN NEGATIVE	घटियापन / लापरवाही Inferior quality or carelessness resulting from bad methods or lack of diligence.	Shoddy workmanship means sloppy, clumsy, and low-grade execution.	• carelessness • sloppiness • inferiority	• meticulousness • excellence • precision
08	**dubious** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	संदिग्ध Hesitating or doubtful; not to be relied upon, morally suspect, or questionable.	Dubious contains 'doubt' — raising serious doubts about legitimacy.	• questionable • suspicious • unreliable	• trustworthy • impeccable • indubitable
09	**restoration** NOUN POSITIVE	बहाली The act of returning something to a former owner, place, or rightful condition.	Re-store: putting something back into its original store or place.	• reinstatement • re-establishment • renewal	• revocation • removal • cancellation
10	**envied** VERB POSITIVE	ईर्ष्या या प्रशंसा का पात्र Regarded with admiration, respect, or longing by others for possessing an advantage.	Envied means being so successful that others wish they had what you have.	• admired • coveted • applauded	• disdained • scorned • pitied

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • UNKIND CUTS: ON THE TELANGANA AND KARNATAKA ELECTORAL ROLLS PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS 5 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**disenfranchisement** NOUN	मताधिकार से वंचित करना The state or act of being deprived of a right or privilege, especially the right to vote.	Dis (deprive) + Franchise (right to vote) = stripping someone of their voting rights.	• disenfranchising • deprivation • disempowerment	• enfranchisement • empowerment • inclusion
02	**in-migration** NOUN	अंतःप्रवासन The process of people moving into a specific region or community to settle.	In (into) + Migration (movement) = people moving into a new region.	• immigration • influx • inflow	• out-migration • emigration • exodus
03	**opacity** NOUN	अपारदर्शिता The state of being unclear, non-transparent, and difficult to understand or scrutinise.	Opaque (not transparent) -> Opacity (quality of being non-transparent).	• non-transparency • obscurity • murkiness	• transparency • clarity • openness
04	**redress** NOUN	निवारण / भरपाई Remedy or compensation for a grievance, wrong, or unfair treatment.	Re-dress: fixing an issue to dress a wound properly again.	• reparations • remedy • rectification	• grievance • injustice • worsening
05	**universal adult franchise** NOUN PHRASE	सार्वभौमिक वयस्क मताधिकार The fundamental democratic principle granting every adult citizen the unconditional right to vote.	Universal (all) + Adult + Franchise (voting rights) = right of every adult to vote.	• universal suffrage • general franchise • voting rights	• voter suppression • disenfranchisement • qualified suffrage

FIXED PREPOSITIONS 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**onus on** NOUN PHRASE	का दायित्व The burden of responsibility or duty placed specifically upon someone.	Onus sounds like 'on us' — meaning the responsibility rests upon us.	• responsibility of • obligation of • burden on	• exemption of • immunity for • relief of

PHRASAL VERBS 4 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Marauding on** VERB PHRASE	विध्वंसक रूप से आगे बढ़ते रहना Continuing to advance aggressively and recklessly in a destructive manner.	Sounds like 'raiding on' — continuing to sweep through destructively.	• pillaging on • rampaging • sweeping aggressively	• halting • retreating • receding
02	**struck out** VERB PHRASE	हटा दिया / काट दिया Removed or erased names officially from an electoral list or register.	Think of striking a line with a pen to cross out a name.	• crossed off • removed • eliminated	• enrolled • included • registered
03	**struck off** VERB PHRASE	सूची से हटा दिया गया Officially removed or cancelled from a register or professional body.	Struck + off: knocking a name clean off the official list.	• deregistered • delisted • disbarred	• reinstated • enrolled • admitted
04	**borne out** VERB PHRASE	पुष्टि होना / सच साबित होना Supported, substantiated, or confirmed by facts, evidence, or data.	If facts 'bear out' a claim, they carry the weight to prove it true.	• corroborated • substantiated • validated	• refuted • contradicted • disproven

IDIOMS & PHRASES 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**at the margins** PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE	मामूली स्तर पर / किनारों पर Only in small, minor, or peripheral aspects rather than at the core.	Margins in a notebook are small edge areas, so changes there are minor.	• peripherally • incrementally • nominally	• substantially • fundamentally • significantly
02	**smoking gun** NOUN PHRASE	प्रत्यक्ष अकाट्य सबूत Incontrovertible, undeniable evidence that clearly proves guilt or malpractice.	A gun with smoke coming out of its barrel is undeniable proof of a recent shot.	• conclusive proof • indisputable evidence • irrefutable proof	• conjecture • circumstantial hint • speculation
03	**under the aegis of** PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE	के संरक्षण / तत्वावधान में With the protection, backing, sponsorship, or guidance of an authority.	In Greek myth, 'Aegis' was Zeus's protective shield.	• under the auspices of • under the guardianship • sponsored by	• independently of • unsupported by • opposed by

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 06
Deferred rivalry: On the U.S. Open →

THE HINDU • SPORTS / TENNIS GRAND SLAM

Deferred rivalry: On the U.S. Open

Injuries and form slumps defer key rivalries, opening paths for contenders at Flushing Meadows.

📅 August 29, 2026 ◷ 2 min read DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The Carlos Alcaraz-Jannik Sinner rivalry is no doubt this era's defining matchup, but it has also been **punctuated by**[1] long pauses. In early 2025, Sinner was absent for three months as he served a doping-related ban; this season, Alcaraz was out of action for four months from mid-April owing to a troublesome wrist. Just when it seemed that the two **leading lights**[2] will come face to face at the US Open starting Sunday, Sinner has been **waylaid**[3] by a knee injury. In 2025, they met six times in six months; there has just been a **solitary**[4] duel in the subsequent nine. In a way, the **postponement**[5] of the battle may suit Alcaraz, for the seven-time Major champion has not played a competitive singles fixture since Barcelona in April. The Spaniard has warmed up for Flushing Meadows with two mixed doubles matches partnering the legendary Serena Williams, but a best-of-five-sets contest is a significant **step-up**[6]. The 23-year-old will open against Roman Safiullin — a **tricky**[7] player who beat Alcaraz in 2023 on a Paris hard-court and reached the Wimbledon fourth round this year — and is **drawn to**[8] meet the **in-form**[9] American Ben Shelton in the quarterfinal. Potential semifinal opponents include 24-time Slam titlist Novak Djokovic and 2021 US Open winner Daniil Medvedev, which makes the defending champion's path challenging.

However, Djokovic and Medvedev are on their own tough journeys. The 39-year-old Serb is no longer the once-renowned hard-court master, and lost his lone match – in Cincinnati – after the semifinal **reverse**[10] to Sinner at Wimbledon. Medvedev was last in a Major final at the 2024 Australian Open and is without a trophy since February. Alexander Zverev thus has a golden opportunity to make his big **breakthrough**[11] on his favourite surface. Without Sinner, the German will be the top seed, and following the French Open triumph and Wimbledon runner-up finish, the 29-year-old will be **confidence personified**[12]. Among women, two-time defending champion Aryna Sabalenka would have liked to be that player, but the Belarusian World No. 1 has **wobbled**[13] of late and seen her lead at the top cut to less than 450 points. Her chief challenger Elena Rybakina may be **racing against time**[14] to recover from an ankle injury, but with Iga Swiatek, Coco Gauff and Jessica Pegula all in impressive form leading into New York, Sabalenka will have a **daunting**[15] task. Wimbledon winner Linda Noskova will be looking for a worthy **follow-up**[16] while the **fast-rising**[17] 21-year-old from the Philippines, Alexandra Eala, will hope to continue her recent **eye-popping**[18] run. With Serena and Venus Williams set to **pair up**[19] in doubles, there will be a rich **sprinkling**[20] of **stardust**[21] too.

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **Punctuated by** (Verb) Interrupted by • बीच-बीच में बाधित होना
2. **Leading lights** (Noun) Top figures • प्रमुख व्यक्ति
3. **Waylaid** (Verb) Delayed • मार्ग में रोका गया
4. **Solitary** (Adjective) Single • एकमात्र / अकेला
5. **Postponement** (Noun) Delay • स्थगन
6. **Step-up** (Noun) Increase • बढ़ोतरी / वृद्धि
7. **Tricky** (Adjective) Difficult • कठिन या चुनौतीपूर्ण
8. **Drawn to** (Verb) Matched with • प्रतिद्वंद्वी के रूप में चुना जाना
9. **In-form** (Adjective) Playing well • उत्कृष्ट फॉर्म में
10. **Reverse** (Noun) Defeat • हार / असफलता
11. **Breakthrough** (Noun) Major success • महत्वपूर्ण सफलता
12. **Confidence personified** (Noun) Extremely confident • आत्मविश्वास की प्रतिमूर्ति
13. **Wobbled** (Verb) Faltered • डगमगाया
14. **Racing against time** (Verb) Hurrying • समय के खिलाफ दौड़ना
15. **Daunting** (Adjective) Intimidating • चुनौतीपूर्ण / कठिन
16. **Follow-up** (Noun) Continuation • अनुवर्ती प्रयास
17. **Fast-rising** (Adjective) Rapidly progressing • तेज़ी से उभरता हुआ
18. **Eye-popping** (Adjective) Astonishing • आश्चर्यजनक
19. **Pair up** (Verb) Team up • जोड़ी बनाना
20. **Sprinkling** (Noun) Small amount • हल्का छिड़काव / थोड़ा अंश
21. **Stardust** (Noun) Glamour • आकर्षण और प्रसिद्धि का जादू

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Source: The Hindu Published: August 29, 2026 12:10 AM IST

EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Deferred rivalry: On the U.S. Open
THE HINDU • SPORTS / TENNIS GRAND SLAM

EDITORIAL STANCE
ANALYTICAL
"examining tournament prospects"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author adopts an analytical tone to evaluate the key contenders, injury setbacks, and draw dynamics ahead of the US Open. By highlighting the absence of Jannik Sinner and the fitness concerns of top players, the passage illustrates how the tournament draw has opened up unpredictably. Ultimately, the piece underscores the shifting momentum and high stakes in contemporary Grand Slam tennis.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY 11 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Waylaid** VERB NEGATIVE	मार्ग में रोका गया Stopped, delayed, or interrupted in progress or along a journey.	Stopped 'on the way' and 'laid' back, causing an unexpected delay.	• intercepted • detained • delayed	• expedited • assisted • advanced
02	**Solitary** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	एकमात्र / अकेला Done or existing alone; single or sole.	Solitary sounds like solo, meaning performed by or existing as one alone.	• sole • single • lone	• multiple • numerous • frequent
03	**Step-up** NOUN POSITIVE	बढ़ोतरी / वृद्धि An increase or advance in size, intensity, or effort required.	Stepping up a staircase takes you to a higher level of exertion or height.	• escalation • increase • advancement	• reduction • step-down • decrease
04	**Tricky** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	कठिन या चुनौतीपूर्ण Requiring care and skill because of difficulty, subtlety, or unexpected obstacles.	Full of unexpected tricks that make handling the situation difficult.	• awkward • challenging • problematic	• straightforward • easy • simple
05	**Reverse** NOUN NEGATIVE	हार / असफलता An unexpected defeat, failure, or setback in a contest.	Moving in reverse in a match means going backwards instead of winning forward.	• setback • defeat • loss	• triumph • victory • success
06	**Wobbled** VERB NEGATIVE	डगमगाया Showed unsteadiness, uncertainty, or hesitation in performance or position.	Wobbling on your feet means losing balance and showing unsteadiness.	• faltered • wavered • stumbled	• stabilised • excelled • persisted
07	**Daunting** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	चुनौतीपूर्ण / कठिन Seeming difficult to deal with in a way that discourages or intimidates.	Daunt sounds like haunt; both create a feeling of fear or intimidation.	• intimidating • formidable • challenging	• encouraging • reassuring • inviting
08	**Follow-up** NOUN NEUTRAL	अनुवर्ती प्रयास Something that continues or builds upon a previous success or effort.	Following a previous effort with another action to maintain momentum.	• sequel • continuation • subsequent action	• prelude • beginning • abandonment
09	**Fast-rising** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	तेज़ी से उभरता हुआ Advancing quickly in status, rank, or popularity.	Rising rapidly through the competitive ranks at high speed.	• up-and-coming • emerging • rapidly advancing	• declining • fading • regressing
10	**Sprinkling** NOUN POSITIVE	हल्का छिड़काव / थोड़ा अंश A small quantity or touch of something scattered throughout.	Sprinkling sugar adds just a small, delightful touch to a dish.	• touch • dash • smattering	• flood • abundance • excess
11	**Stardust** NOUN POSITIVE	आकर्षण और प्रसिद्धि का जादू A magical or charismatic quality associated with famous or talented individuals.	Dust left behind by stars that adds magical glamour and appeal.	• glamour • charisma • magic	• dullness • drabness • ordinariness

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • DEFERRED RIVALRY: ON THE U.S. OPEN PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Postponement** NOUN	स्थगन The act of delaying an event or arrangement to a later time.	'Post' means after, so placing an event after its intended time is a postponement.	• deferral • delay • adjournment	• advancement • continuation • expedition
02	**Breakthrough** NOUN	महत्वपूर्ण सफलता A dramatic and important discovery or success that overcomes a major hurdle.	Breaking through a firm barrier to achieve a long-awaited success.	• triumph • leap forward • advancement	• setback • failure • stalemate

FIXED PREPOSITIONS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Punctuated by** VERB	बीच-बीच में बाधित होना Interrupted at intervals by specific events or occurrences.	Punctuation marks like commas create pauses in a sentence; similarly, events punctuate time.	• interrupted by • broken up by • interspersed with	• uninterrupted • continuous • sustained
02	**Drawn to** VERB	प्रतिद्वंद्वी के रूप में चुना जाना Scheduled or selected to play against a specific opponent in a tournament fixture.	In sports, tournament lots are drawn to determine who faces whom.	• paired against • pitted against • matched with	• separated from • avoided

PHRASAL VERBS 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Pair up** VERB	जोड़ी बनाना To join together to form a team or partnership for a activity.	Joining together to form a pair or dynamic duo.	• team up • partner • unite	• separate • disband • split up

IDIOMS & PHRASES 5 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Leading lights** NOUN	प्रमुख व्यक्ति Prominent or influential people who lead a particular domain or field.	A light that leads shines brighter than others, standing out as a top performer.	• luminaries • celebrities • vips	• nobodies • nonentities • underdogs
02	**In-form** ADJECTIVE	उत्कृष्ट फॉर्म में Performing consistently well and exhibiting top physical or mental condition.	Literally being 'in' good peak fitness and performance form.	• peak • on fire • thriving	• out-of-form • slumping • struggling
03	**Confidence personified** NOUN	आत्मविश्वास की प्रतिमूर्ति An individual who perfectly embodies supreme self-assurance and poise.	A person so full of self-belief that they personify or embody confidence itself.	• embodiment of confiden • supremely confident • self-assured	• insecure • self-doubting • diffident
04	**Racing against time** VERB	समय के खिलाफ दौड़ना Attempting urgently to accomplish or complete something before a deadline expires.	Running in a race where the ticking clock is your main opponent.	• hurrying • rushing • working against the cloc	• taking one's time • dawdling • delaying
05	**Eye-popping** ADJECTIVE	आश्चर्यजनक Extremely striking, impressive, or surprising.	Something so amazing or unexpected that it makes your eyes pop open in surprise.	• spectacular • astonishing • stunning	• unremarkable • ordinary • unimpressive

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 09
Policy mistakes, not ethanol, are behind sugar price rise →

THE INDIAN EXPRESS • AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS & TRADE POLICY

Policy mistakes, not ethanol, are behind sugar price rise

Flawed regulatory interventions rather than ethanol diversion have triggered the soaring domestic sugar prices.

📅 August 29, 2026 ◷ 2 min read DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Sugar has always been a political **commodity**[1] in India. It has become more so with the rise in retail prices — from an average of Rs 45 to Rs 65 per kg within a month — that is being **blamed on**[2] the ethanol-blended petrol programme. The truth is more complex — and bitter. Only 27.5 per cent of ethanol supplied by distilleries to oil marketing companies in 2025-26 is being produced from sugarcane juice and **molasses**[3]; the balance is coming from cereal grains. Also, the estimated 3 million tonnes (mt) of sugar **diverted**[4] for making ethanol would be hardly a tenth of the 30.9 mt gross production during the year ended September 2026. The **preceding**[5] four sugar years had also seen diversions of 3.5 mt, 2.4 mt, 4.3 mt and 3.6 mt respectively, but without causing price **spikes**[6]. Ethanol **per se**[7] clearly isn't the villain here.

The current price **spiral**[8] has more to do with sugar output itself turning out much lower — from an initial 34.4 mt gross projection made at the start of crushing in November. The **shortfall**[9] of 3.5 mt should have been **anticipated**[10] much earlier — at least by February, when mills in Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra were struggling to get cane and even shutting down crushing operations. The government was late to react. It banned exports in mid-May. When ex-factory prices started really **soaring**[11] from July, as **deficient**[12] June monsoon rains raised concerns over cane yields and production prospects for the upcoming 2026-27 sugar year too, it **went into overdrive**[13]. A stock limit of 400 tonnes, along with the condition of not holding any sugar beyond 30 days, was imposed on all dealers. Mills were further, as part of a stock verification exercise, directed to **furnish**[14] details of all bulk consumers to whom they had sold 500 tonnes or more. These **knee-jerk**[15] panic actions only **added fuel to the fire**[16].

The simple thing the government should have done is keep the import window open. Rather than banning exports, the **tariff**[17] on both raw and white sugar imports could have been **slashed**[18] from 100 per cent to zero by April, when most mills had stopped crushing. The sugar industry is a classic story of controls — the government deciding everything from the pricing of cane to how much each mill can sell in the open market during a particular month — that are **destined to**[19] fail. This sugar crisis is a result of the government neither investing in **market intelligence**[20] nor allowing market forces to do the job of balancing supply and demand. In short, a policy failure.

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **commodity** (Noun) product • पण्य / व्यापारिक वस्तु
2. **blamed on** (Verb) attributed to • के लिए दोष ठहराना
3. **molasses** (Noun) syrup • शीरा / राब
4. **diverted** (Verb) rerouted • मोड़ दिया
5. **preceding** (Adjective) previous • पूर्ववर्ती
6. **spikes** (Noun) surges • अचानक तेज वृद्धि
7. **per se** (Adverb) in itself • अपने आप में
8. **spiral** (Noun) escalation • निरंतर तीव्र वृद्धि या गिरावट का चक्र
9. **shortfall** (Noun) deficit • कमी / घाटा
10. **anticipated** (Verb) foreseen • पूर्वानुमान लगाया
11. **soaring** (Adjective) rising rapidly • आसमान छूता हुआ
12. **deficient** (Adjective) inadequate • अपर्याप्त / कम
13. **went into overdrive** (Phrase) worked intensely • अतिसक्रिय हो जाना
14. **furnish** (Verb) provide • प्रस्तुत करना / मुहैया कराना
15. **knee-jerk** (Adjective) unthinking • बिना सोचे-समझे की गई तुरंत प्रतिक्रिया
16. **added fuel to the fire** (Phrase) worsened the situation • आग में घी डालना
17. **tariff** (Noun) import duty • आयात शुल्क
18. **slashed** (Verb) reduced drastically • भारी कटौती की
19. **destined to** (Adjective) bound to • तय होना / पूर्वनिर्धारित होना
20. **market intelligence** (Noun) industry data • बाजार से जुड़ी सटीक जानकारी

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Source: The Indian Express Published: August 29, 2026 06:00 AM IST

EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Policy mistakes, not ethanol, are behind sugar price rise
THE INDIAN EXPRESS • AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS & TRADE POLICY

EDITORIAL STANCE
CRITICAL
"fault-finding and disapproving"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author critically evaluates the government's regulatory missteps and administrative panic regarding soaring sugar prices. By presenting statistical evidence, the writer demonstrates that ethanol blending is a scapegoat for supply mismanagement and delayed import tariff rationalisation. The editorial firmly advocates for trusting market forces over heavy-handed, counterproductive state controls.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY 13 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**commodity** NOUN NEUTRAL	पण्य / व्यापारिक वस्तु A raw material or primary agricultural product that can be bought and sold.	Think of 'common utility' items that are traded in bulk markets as commodities.	• merchandise • produce • ware	• service • finished product • custom good
02	**diverted** VERB NEUTRAL	मोड़ दिया Caused someone or something to change course or turn from one direction to another.	'Di-' (two/apart) + 'vert' (turn) = turned in another direction.	• redirected • deflected • channelled	• maintained • retained • kept
03	**preceding** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	पूर्ववर्ती Coming or occurring immediately before something else in time, order, or position.	'Pre' means before; preceding is whatever comes immediately before.	• prior • former • antecedent	• succeeding • following • subsequent
04	**spikes** NOUN NEGATIVE	अचानक तेज वृद्धि Sharp, sudden, and often temporary increases in prices or rates.	A 'spike' is sharp and points straight up, just like a sudden jump on a price graph.	• surges • jumps • escalations	• plummets • drops • slumps
05	**spiral** NOUN NEGATIVE	निरंतर तीव्र वृद्धि या गिरावट का चक्र A continuous and rapid increase or decrease in prices, wages, or quantities.	A spiral winds continuously outwards and upwards without stopping.	• escalation • surge • chain reaction	• stabilisation • plateau • equilibrium
06	**shortfall** NOUN NEGATIVE	कमी / घाटा A deficit of something required or expected, falling below the target.	Falling 'short' of the expected requirement leaves a shortfall.	• deficit • scarcity • deficiency	• surplus • excess • glut
07	**anticipated** VERB NEUTRAL	पूर्वानुमान लगाया Regarded as probable; expected or predicted in advance.	To 'participate' in advance by thinking ahead equals 'anticipate'.	• foreseen • predicted • expected	• unforeseen • overlooked • ignored
08	**soaring** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	आसमान छूता हुआ Increasing or rising rapidly above the normal level.	Like an eagle soaring high into the sky, prices shoot upwards quickly.	• escalating • skyrocketing • spiralling	• plummeting • declining • dropping
09	**deficient** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अपर्याप्त / कम Not having enough of a specified quality, resource, or quantity.	'Deficit' + 'ient' -> lacking something essential in quantity.	• inadequate • scant • insufficient	• abundant • plentiful • sufficient
10	**furnish** VERB NEUTRAL	प्रस्तुत करना / मुहैया कराना To supply or provide necessary information, details, or data.	Just as you furnish a room with items, you furnish an office with official documents.	• supply • submit • present	• withhold • suppress • conceal
11	**knee-jerk** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	बिना सोचे-समझे की गई तुरंत प्रतिक्रिया Characterised by an automatic, unthinking, and hasty reaction without deliberation.	Like a doctor tapping your knee, triggering an involuntary kick with zero thought.	• impulsive • reflexive • ill-considered	• deliberate • measured • premeditated
12	**slashed** VERB NEUTRAL	भारी कटौती की Reduced something greatly and abruptly, such as prices, rates, or tariffs.	Slashing with a sword cuts things in half or drops them sharply.	• curtailed • chopped • lowered	• raised • increased • augmented
13	**market intelligence** NOUN POSITIVE	बाजार से जुड़ी सटीक जानकारी Information and analysis relevant to a company or government's markets, gathered to make confident decisions.	Applying 'intelligence' (information gathering) directly to 'market' dynamics.	• market research • commercial data • trade insights	• ignorance • misinformation • blindness

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • POLICY MISTAKES, NOT ETHANOL, ARE BEHIND SUGAR PRICE RISE PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**molasses** NOUN	शीरा / राब A thick, dark brown juice obtained from raw sugar during the refining process.	Sounds like 'mole' + 'passes' through thick brown sweet liquid.	• treacle • syrup • concentrate	• refined sugar • crystal • distillate
02	**tariff** NOUN	आयात शुल्क A tax or duty to be paid on a particular class of imports or exports.	Tariff is a tax traffic control on cross-border items.	• duty • levy • customs	• subsidy • rebate • exemption

FIXED PREPOSITIONS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**blamed on** VERB	के लिए दोष ठहराना Held responsible for a fault or negative outcome.	When you put the 'blame ON' something, you place the responsibility on its shoulders.	• ascribed to • assigned to • pinned on	• credited to • absolved from • exonerated from
02	**destined to** ADJECTIVE	तय होना / पूर्वनिर्धारित होना Certain or bound to do, experience, or be something according to fate or logic.	'Destiny' determines what something is destined 'to' achieve or suffer.	• fated to • doomed to • predetermined to	• unlikely to • free to • optional

IDIOMS & PHRASES 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**went into overdrive** VERB	अतिसक्रिय हो जाना Began to work or act with great energy, intensity, or extreme haste.	Putting a car into overdrive makes the engine operate at maximum capacity.	• accelerated • intensified • stepped up	• slowed down • relaxed • decelerated
02	**added fuel to the fire** VERB	आग में घी डालना Exacerbated an already difficult or volatile situation.	Throwing petrol/fuel onto flames makes the fire burn much worse.	• exacerbated • inflamed • aggravated	• mitigated • alleviated • assuaged

FOREIGN WORDS 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**per se** ADVERB	अपने आप में By or in itself or themselves; intrinsically.	Latin phrase meaning 'by itself'— focusing solely on the core subject alone.	• intrinsically • essentially • fundamentally	• extrinsically • contextually • externally

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 12
Need to break Manipur's cycle of reprisal →

THE INDIAN EXPRESS • INTERNAL SECURITY & GOVERNANCE

Need to break Manipur's cycle of reprisal

Manipur urgently requires genuine inter-community dialogue and disarmament to halt escalating ethnic violence.

📅 August 29, 2026 ◷ 2 min read DAILY EDITORIAL READER

More than three years after the Meitei-Kuki clashes **plunged**[2] Manipur into a **prolonged**[3] conflict, a political settlement between the two communities remains **out of reach**[4]. The state now faces a deepening Kuki-Naga **fault line**[5]. The killing of four Naga civilians this week in Kuki-dominated Kangpokpi district **perpetuates**[6] the disturbing cycle of violence. It comes after the murder of Kuki-Thadou church pastors in May, which was followed by **retaliatory**[7] **abductions**[8] on both sides; a month later, the bodies of six Naga men were recovered. Other episodes of killing and houses being **set ablaze**[9] have kept the state **on edge**[10]. The state government must immediately identify the **perpetrators**[11] of the recent violence and arrest them. But it will need to do much more to break the chain of violence.

The growing difficulty in ensuring the peaceful **co-existence**[12] of communities is evident in the **blockades**[13] imposed by Meitei, Kuki and Naga groups, which have turned Manipur's roads and highways into **contested**[14] spaces. The **blockades**[13] **disrupt**[15] supplies, raise the cost of food and fuel, and restrict access to healthcare. Kangpokpi district — between Naga-dominated Senapati district to the north and the Meitei-dominated valley districts to the south — is the worst affected. Recent RTI data has revealed that more than 700 **internally displaced**[16] people have died in relief camps. Security forces have had very little success in ensuring the safe movement of **convoys**[17] carrying essential supplies.

The return of a state government, led by Yumnam Khemchand Singh, in February, after almost a year of President's Rule, had offered hopes of **reconciliation**[18]. That the government led by a Meitei chief minister, with deputy CMs from the Kuki and Naga communities, has so far found little success in pulling the state **back from the brink**[19] shows how deeply the divisions have hardened. Political representation alone cannot resolve the conflict when the communities remain socially **segregated**[20]. Dialogue and a sustained political process, in which all communities **have a stake**[21] and civil society leaders are **empowered**[22], are the only ways forward. Every claim over land and identity cannot be resolved overnight; the immediate goal must be to establish a framework in which people can safely move, trade and live as neighbours. The **disarming**[23] of militant groups and a **crackdown on**[24] extremist elements, too, must be pursued with equal urgency.

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **reprisal** (Noun) retaliation • प्रतिशोध / बदले की कार्रवाई
2. **plunged** (Verb) pushed suddenly • झोंक दिया / धकेल दिया
3. **prolonged** (Adjective) lengthy • लंबे समय तक चलने वाला
4. **out of reach** (Phrase) unachievable • पहुंच से बाहर
5. **fault line** (Noun) deep division • विभाजन रेखा / दरार
6. **perpetuates** (Verb) continues • निरंतर बनाए रखना
7. **retaliatory** (Adjective) vengeful • प्रतिशोधात्मक / बदले की भावना से
8. **abductions** (Noun) kidnappings • अपहरण
9. **set ablaze** (Phrase) torched • आग के हवाले करना
10. **on edge** (Phrase) tense • बेचैन / तनावग्रस्त
11. **perpetrators** (Noun) culprits • अपराधी / दोषी
12. **co-existence** (Noun) living together • सह-अस्तित्व
13. **blockades** (Noun) barricades • नाकेबंदी
14. **contested** (Adjective) disputed • विवादित
15. **disrupt** (Verb) interrupt • बाधित करना
16. **internally displaced** (Adjective) homeless inside homeland • आंतरिक रूप से विस्थापित
17. **convoys** (Noun) guarded fleets • काफिले / पहरेदार दल
18. **reconciliation** (Noun) peacemaking • सुलह / मेल-मिलाप
19. **back from the brink** (Phrase) saved from disaster • तबाही के कगार से वापस लाना
20. **segregated** (Adjective) separated • अलग-थलग / पृथक
21. **have a stake** (Phrase) have an interest • हित / हिस्सेदारी होना
22. **empowered** (Adjective) given authority • सशक्त / अधिकार प्राप्त
23. **disarming** (Noun) taking weapons away • निःशस्त्रीकरण
24. **crackdown on** (Noun / phrasal form) harsh action against • कड़ी कार्रवाई

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Source: The Indian Express Published: August 29, 2026 07:00 AM IST

EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Need to break Manipur's cycle of reprisal
THE INDIAN EXPRESS • INTERNAL SECURITY & GOVERNANCE

EDITORIAL STANCE
CAUTIONARY
"warning of worsening conflict"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author highlights the alarming escalation of ethnic conflict in Manipur, which now threatens to engulf Naga communities alongside Meiteis and Kukis. The piece argues that mere political power-sharing is insufficient without social reconciliation, disarmament, and restoring freedom of movement. It strongly warns authorities to urgently break the self-perpetuating cycle of retaliation before the crisis deepens further.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY 9 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**plunged** VERB NEGATIVE	झोंक दिया / धकेल दिया Suddenly and forcefully pushed into a serious, difficult, or distressing state.	Imagine a plunger forcefully pushing something deep down into murky water.	• cast • thrust • hurled	• extricated • rescued • retrieved
02	**prolonged** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	लंबे समय तक चलने वाला Continuing for an extended or unusually long period of time.	Pro + Long -> extended for a very long duration.	• protracted • extended • sustained	• fleeting • brief • short-lived
03	**perpetuates** VERB NEGATIVE	निरंतर बनाए रखना Causes an undesirable situation or belief to continue without end.	Related to 'perpetual' (never-ending) -> keeping something going indefinitely.	• sustains • prolongs • maintains	• terminates • halts • extinguishes
04	**retaliatory** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	प्रतिशोधात्मक / बदले की भावना से Characterised by an intention to retaliate or strike back against a past harm.	Think of 'tit-for-tat' -> returning harm with more harm in retaliation.	• reciprocal • avenging • punitive	• conciliatory • forgiving • pacifying
05	**blockades** NOUN NEGATIVE	नाकेबंदी Acts of sealing off a place to prevent goods, vehicles, or people from entering or leaving.	Block + ade -> an organised barrier set up to block traffic or trade.	• sieges • barriers • obstructions	• openings • access • clearances
06	**contested** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	विवादित Subject to active dispute, rivalry, or struggle for control.	In a contest, two sides fight over a prize; a contested space is disputed.	• disputed • contentious • challenged	• uncontested • settled • undisputed
07	**disrupt** VERB NEGATIVE	बाधित करना Interrupt the normal continuity or operation of a process or system.	Dis (apart) + rupt (break/burst) -> breaking apart the normal smooth flow.	• interrupt • disturb • dislocate	• facilitate • assist • streamline
08	**segregated** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अलग-थलग / पृथक Kept separate from others, especially on basis of race, ethnicity, or class.	Se- (apart) + greg (flock) -> keeping groups of people separated from the main flock.	• isolated • partitioned • divided	• integrated • united • assimilated
09	**empowered** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	सशक्त / अधिकार प्राप्त Endowed with the official authority, confidence, or resources to make decisions.	Em- (give) + power -> granted the authority and confidence to act.	• authorised • enabled • enfranchised	• disempowered • handicapped • marginalised

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • NEED TO BREAK MANIPUR'S CYCLE OF REPRISAL PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS 8 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**reprisal** NOUN	प्रतिशोध / बदले की कार्रवाई An act of deliberate retaliation against an enemy or adversary for an injury suffered.	Sound association: 'Re-prize' -> paying someone back with an unwelcome prize/counter-attack.	• retaliation • retribution • vengeance	• forgiveness • pardon • reconciliation
02	**abductions** NOUN	अपहरण Instances of taking someone away unlawfully and by force or deception.	Ab- (away) + duct (lead) -> leading someone away unlawfully.	• kidnappings • seizures • captures	• releases • liberations • rescues
03	**perpetrators** NOUN	अपराधी / दोषी Persons who carry out harmful, illegal, or immoral acts.	Perpetrator -> person who commits a crime (perpetrates it).	• culprits • offenders • transgressors	• victims • innocents • defenders
04	**co-existence** NOUN	सह-अस्तित्व The state of living together peacefully despite differences or competing interests.	Co (together) + existence (living) -> living peacefully in the same space.	• harmony • concord • cohabitation	• conflict • hostility • discord
05	**internally displaced** ADJECTIVE	आंतरिक रूप से विस्थापित Forced to flee one's home due to conflict or disaster while remaining within one's national borders.	Displaced (removed from place) while still internal (within country borders).	• uprooted • dispossessed • evicted	• settled • repatriated • rooted
06	**convoys** NOUN	काफिले / पहरेदार दल Groups of vehicles or ships travelling together, often with an escort for protection.	Con- (together) + voy (voyage) -> vehicles travelling together on a journey for mutual protection.	• cavalry • fleets • processions	• stragglers • lone vehicles • solitary units
07	**reconciliation** NOUN	सुलह / मेल-मिलाप The restoration of friendly and harmonious relations between previously hostile parties.	Re-concile -> re-establishing a friendly council/relation after a quarrel.	• rapprochement • pacification • settlement	• estrangement • alienation • hostility
08	**disarming** NOUN	निःशस्त्रीकरण The process of depriving individuals or groups of their weapons and military equipment.	Dis- (remove) + arm (weapons) -> stripping of weapons.	• demilitarisation • decommissioning • demobilisation	• arming • militarisation • weaponisation

PHRASAL VERBS 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**crackdown on** NOUN / PHRASAL FORM	कड़ी कार्रवाई A series of severe, decisive enforcement measures taken to suppress unlawful activity.	Cracking down the whip onto offenders to enforce strict discipline.	• clampdown on • suppression of • curb on	• leniency towards • tolerance of • indulgence in

IDIOMS & PHRASES 6 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**out of reach** PHRASE	पहुंच से बाहर Beyond someone's power to attain, achieve, or influence.	If something is beyond your arm's reach, you cannot grab or achieve it.	• unattainable • inaccessible • unachievable	• accessible • attainable • within grasp
02	**fault line** NOUN	विभाजन रेखा / दरार A significant point of division, vulnerability, or friction between differing groups.	In geography, a fault line is a crack where earthquakes start; socially, it causes strife.	• divide • rift • cleavage	• unity • solidarity • cohesion
03	**set ablaze** PHRASE	आग के हवाले करना Caused to burn violently with bright and destructive flames.	'A-blaze' refers to blazing flames spreading all over.	• ignited • incinerated • torched	• extinguished • doused • quenched
04	**on edge** PHRASE	बेचैन / तनावग्रस्त In a state of continuous nervous tension, anxiety, or unease.	Standing on the edge of a cliff naturally makes you nervous and alert.	• anxious • apprehensive • jittery	• calm • composed • serene
05	**back from the brink** PHRASE	तबाही के कगार से वापस लाना Retreating or recovering from the critical point of an imminent disaster.	'Brink' is the extreme edge of a steep drop; stepping back means averting catastrophe.	• averted crisis • pulled back from disaste • narrowly rescued	• over the edge • headlong into ruin • past point of no return
06	**have a stake** PHRASE	हित / हिस्सेदारी होना To have a direct personal, financial, or political interest and involvement in an outcome.	Driving your wooden stake into the ground to claim a share of the land.	• have a share • be invested • hold an interest	• be indifferent • have no concern • disinterest

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TODAY'S EDITORIALS
ONE STEP AHEAD EVERYDAY ★

📅 AUGUST 29, 2026

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